

SAMANTHA HAVAS

0→1 Products · AI-Assisted Design · Rapid Prototyping

+14015752313

samhavasdesign@gmail.com

www.samhavas.com

linkedin.com/in/samanthahavas

Senior Product Designer with 10+ years of experience leading 0→1 product design – from strategy and user research through launch and iteration. Experience spans consumer products, marketplaces, and design systems, partnering cross-functionally with product and engineering to turn complex problems into intuitive, scalable experiences. Uses AI tools and rapid prototyping to accelerate exploration and ship faster.

EXPERIENCE

Lead Product Designer (Contract), Avianu Jul 2026 - Present

- Lead end-to-end product design across multiple client engagements, partnering directly with stakeholders and engineering teams from product strategy and early UX through production-ready design.
- Own product design for Blez, a mobile marketplace platform, developing user flows, wireframes, high-fidelity UI, and scalable components from concept through launch.
- Lead a design system audit and redesign for Rethink, evolving its visual identity, component system, and product experience alongside a functional Next.js prototype.
- Design and evolve enterprise components and design systems for clients including Trellix, improving consistency, scalability, and developer handoff.

Product Design / UX Expert (Contract), Mercor Jun 2026 - Present

- Apply senior-level product design judgment to evaluate AI-generated product experiences for research supporting a leading frontier AI company.
- Assess AI-generated interfaces and product concepts across usability, interaction design, visual quality, information architecture, and adherence to product requirements.
- Evaluate user journeys, mockups, and functional prototypes against detailed criteria, identifying UX issues and providing structured feedback used in AI model research and evaluation.

Senior Product Designer, Angi Jan 2022 - Jan 2026

- Owned design for core consumer surfaces (homepage, sales funnel, and SEO landing pages) on a platform generating \$3M+ in daily revenue, driving measurable improvements through iterative testing and personalization.
- Increased user engagement by 33% by redesigning navigation and pro-selection flows, aligning cross-functional teams around a directory-first marketplace model.
- Built and scaled a component library for the Growth organization, reducing design-to-development handoff time by 20% and improving consistency across Angi and HomeAdvisor platforms.
- Improved SEO performance by designing interactive, indexable components, reducing bounce rates by 15% and increasing organic discoverability.
- Mentored 2 designers through structured critiques and cross-functional collaboration, helping elevate team output and design quality.

Product Designer, *HOMER* Apr 2020 - Jan 2022

- Led zero-to-one product design for a Sesame Street-backed social-emotional learning app, owning end-to-end UX from concept through launch – wireframes, UI design, usability testing, and design system creation.
- Increased child engagement by 25% by optimizing core app flows (ages 2-6) through iterative UX design and playtesting insights.
- Conducted qualitative and quantitative research (interviews, surveys, field testing) to inform product decisions and prioritize features.
- Designed monetization flows and lifecycle marketing assets (landing pages, email), contributing to a 15% increase in user acquisition.

Lead Digital Designer, *Saranko Creative Studio* Jun 2019 - Apr 2020

- Delivered digital campaigns for AMEX, Sephora, and other clients, increasing engagement by 20%.

Lead Visual Designer, *Stackla* Sep 2016 - Jun 2019

- Rebranded Stackla's visual identity, increasing demo requests by 31%, and launched a microsite that generated 500+ qualified leads.

Graphic Designer, *Newmark, Cornish & Carey* Aug 2015 - Sep 2016

- Produced brand campaigns, websites, infographics, and print collateral while mentoring a junior designer.

Graphic Designer, *DTZ* Dec 2013 - Aug 2015

- Supported a company-wide rebrand during the DTZ acquisition, producing digital and print assets.

EDUCATION

Boston University, BFA in Graphic Design, 2013

General Assembly, Certificate in UX Design, 2017

SKILLS

Product Design, 0→1 Product Design, Product Strategy, UX Strategy, AI Product Design, Design Systems, Interaction Design, Rapid Prototyping, User Research, A/B Testing & Experimentation, Conversion Rate Optimization (CRO), Accessibility (WCAG), Cross-Functional Collaboration, Design Leadership & Mentorship

TOOLS

Figma, Cursor, Claude Code, v0, Next.js, Vercel, GitHub, Storybook, Amplitude, UserTesting, Maze, Miro, Jira, Zeroheight, Adobe Creative Suite